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Bus

How Taipei's joint-operation bus network is numbered, coloured and paid for.

Network

The joint-operation system — one brand, one fare structure, many private companies — and the route numbering that encodes more than it appears to.

The joint-operation network

Around 280 routes, fourteen private companies and one brand. Four city regulations set out how the money actually moves — and the central revenue pool everyone repeats is in none of them.

Taipei's city buses run as 聯營公車 — a joint operation: private companies operating under one fare structure, one numbering scheme and one brand, so that to a passenger it looks like a single network when it is not. That structural fact — how many companies, how many routes, and the four city regulations that actually set out how the money moves — is explained in full on the joint-operation network [\[/bus/network/joint-operation/\]](/bus/network/joint-operation/).

What comes next

The network itself, before anything else. Taipei's city buses run as 聯營公車 — a joint operation. Private companies operate under one fare structure, one numbering scheme and one brand, so that to a passenger it looks like a single network when it is not. That structural fact is the most valuable thing this section can explain, almost no English source states it, and it is why Network [\[/bus/network/\]](/bus/network/) sits above the operator and route pages rather than below them.

Operators. More than a dozen companies work the network under contract, each with its own fleet, liveries and garages. The relationships between them — including who owns whom — are poorly documented in English, which makes this the part most likely to be worth reading rather than merely present.

Routes. The trunk corridors to begin with — the numbered services and the bus lanes along Zhongxiao, Renai, Xinyi and Nanjing — rather than attempting the lot. Taipei City and New Taipei between them run several hundred routes, and a few hundred stub pages would be worth less than twenty written ones. The route *numbering system* itself needs an explainer before any route page makes sense.

Vehicles and garages. Fleet lists exist through enthusiast sources and operator publications; they churn constantly, which is why [Models](/bus/models/) and [Garages](/buses/garages/) wait for a data pipeline rather than a transcription.

Fares and payment. Section-based fares, the EasyCard transfer discount between bus and metro, and where the section boundaries actually fall — which is the thing visitors get wrong most often.

Operators and routes come after the network explainer rather than alongside it, for a reason specific to buses: metro station data comes from MOTC's open data platform — authoritative, stable, slow to change. Bus route data is published per-operator and per-municipality, changes far more often, and the English-language versions of it go out of date quickly. Covering it honestly needs a data pipeline rather than a transcription, so operator and route pages wait on that rather than on effort.

See [about](/about/) for how this site sources material.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operator TRTC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-10; source last updated 2020-01-31. Provenance.